AI for Busy Professionals: No Experience, No Coding, Just Efficiency

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CLAIR SULLIVAN
& ASSOCIATES

ICE BREAKER

Outline

- Introductions
- Course structure and ground rules
- Course resources
- 2 Key Concepts
- Module 1: Welcome and Foundations
- Module 2: Summarization
- Module 3: Text Generation
- Module 4: Data Analysis
- Module 5: Image Generation
- Module 6: Agentic AI
- Module 7: Prompt Library Build and Wrap Up

Approximate schedule

9:00 - 9:10	Orientation
9:10 - 10:00	Module 1
10:00 - 10:05	BREAK
10:05 - 11:00	Module 2
11:00 - 11:05	BREAK
11:05 - 12:00	Module 3
12:00 - 12:30	MIDPOINT BREAK
12:30 - 1:25	Module 4
1:25 - 1:30	BREAK
1:30 - 2:25	Module 5
2:25 - 2:30	BREAK
2:30 - 3:30	Module 6
3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Introductions

- My background
  - University Professor at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
  - Machine Learning Engineer at GitHub
  - Developer Relations Advocate at Neo4j
  - Director of Data Science at Vail Resorts
- Presently running my own company
  - Coding
  - Consulting
  - Education

SURVEY

Structure and ground rules

- Everyone is a beginner at some point
- No bad questions
- Ask questions early, often
- Share your learnings with the cohort
- Hands on, laboratory-like environment!
- Do not be afraid to experiment
- Use your preferred LLM
- Infinite flexibility in our day!
- Take breaks when you need them
    - 1 hour “lunch” break

What I promise you

- I will answer all of your questions!
  - If I do not know the answer, I will get back to you with the answer
- I will keep things flexible throughout the day
  - This is all about your education and transformation!
- When I am showing you something generated with GenAI, I will say so

What I cannot guarantee

- We cannot touch on every single GenAI tool
- You will not hit the limits of the free tools you are using today
- We will not be creating our own agents directly
  - Although we will be using them and I will show how to do agentic work in the various platforms

Course tools and resources

- Maven course site
- GitHub repository (https://github.com/ClairSullivan-Associates/genai_nontech)
- Poll Everywhere (PollEv.com/clairsullivan399)
- My email: clair@clairsullivan.com
- The tools I will use today
  - ChatGPT (chatgpt.com)
  - Claude (claude.ai)
  - Copilot (copilot.microsoft.com)
  - Gemini (gemini.google.com)
  - Google Sheets (including Gemini)

2 Key Concepts of the Course

1. GenAI is here to stay. Like the advent of computers or the internet, staying successful in your workplace requires knowing how to use it as a tool (NOT a human replacement!) to get work done.
2. Getting started with GenAI is simple and extracting overall workplace efficiencies out of it does not need to be complicated if you use some simple rules and frameworks for prompting it.

Module 1: Welcome and Foundations

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. There are some things that GenAI does well, some things it does poorly, and some things it will fool you that it does well but it actually makes up.
2. The art of getting good results out of GenAI involves knowing how to ask it to do things in appropriate ways. You must learn how to CRAFT the prompt.

Generative AI

Companies Are Laying Off Workers Because of AI's Potential—Not Its Performance

by Thomas H. Davenport and Laks Srinivasan

January 29, 2026, Updated February 2, 2026

HBR Staff using AI

https://hbr.org/2026/01/companies-are-laying-off-workers-because-of-ais-potential-not-its-performance?ab=HP-hero-for-you-1

Summary

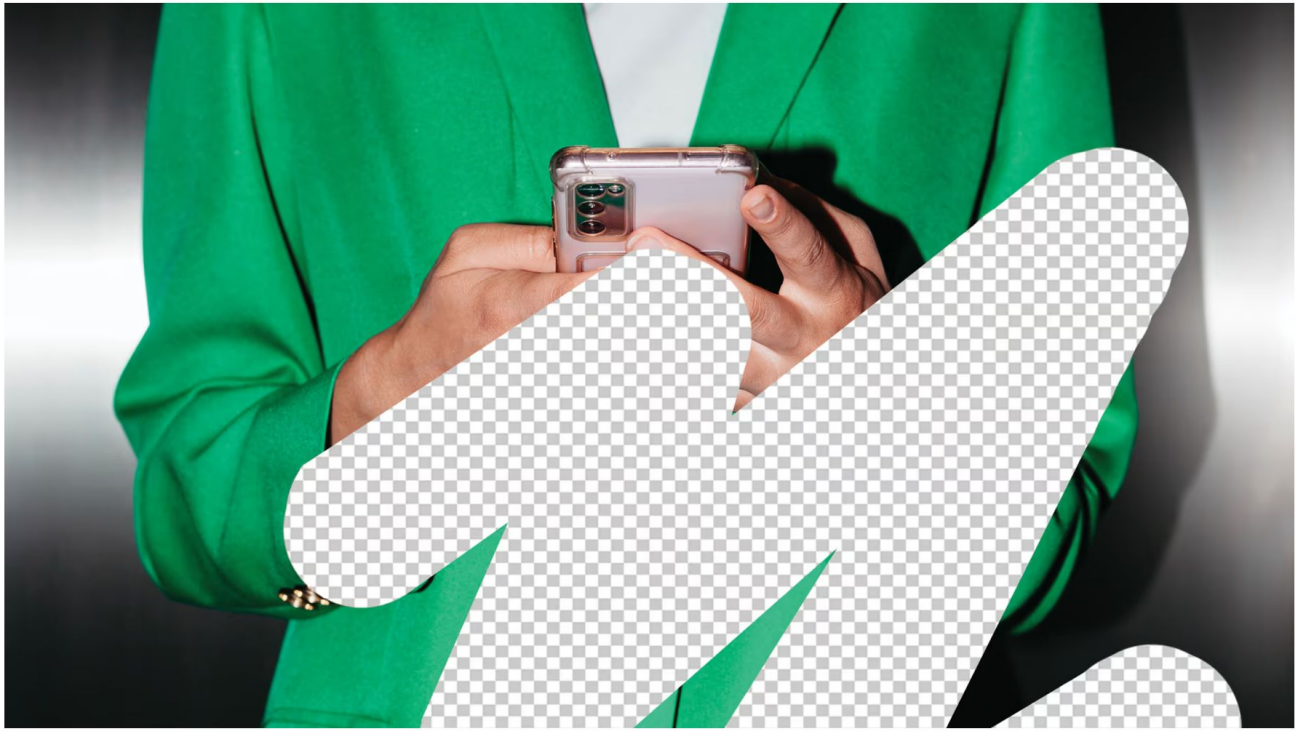
- AI is driving layoffs based on anticipation, not actual results
  - 60% of organizations already reducing or slowing hiring in anticipation of future AI impact
  - Only 2% have done so based on actual AI implementation
- AI replaces specific tasks, not entire jobs
- 44% of executives say GenAI is the hardest form of AI to assess for economic value
  - 90% still report their organizations are getting moderate or great value from AI overall
- Premature AI layoff announcements create serious cultural damage
  - Klarna, which cut its workforce by 40% for AI reasons and then had to rehire because prioritizing lower costs led to lower quality

Managing People

Why Gen AI Feels So Threatening to Workers

And what leaders can do to ease the anxiety. by Erik Hermann, Stefano Puntoni and Carey K. Morewedge

From the Magazine (March–April 2026)



Viktor Solomin/Stocksy

https://hbr.org/2026/03/why-gen-ai-feels-so-threatening-to-workers

Summary

- Worker resistance to gen AI is widespread and significant
  - 45% of CEOs reporting that most employees are either resistant or openly hostile to GenAI
  - 51% of workers using it regularly compared to 85% of leaders and 78% of managers
- Maladaptive resistance is more common than leaders realize
  - 31% of knowledge workers admitting to actively working against their company's AI initiatives
  - 54% saying they would use AI tools without formal approval
- "A significant part of the problem is that most companies lack a change management strategy for implementing gen AI and don't provide formal training to help employees use it."
  - "...only 36% of employees felt properly trained to use gen AI tools."

The big reframe

- GenAI is a thought partner, not a search engine or magic
- The messiest, most time-consuming parts of your job are often exactly what GenAI does best
- Garbage In, Garbage Out (GIGO)
  - Your prompts are everything!
- It will get things wrong sometimes
  - You are still the expert
  - A “draft machine”

The shift is not about learning a tool. It is about learning a new way to think and collaborate.

How GenAI actually works

- Trained on large portions of the internet, books, other text
- Learned patterns in language, did not memorize
- Generates responses based on the patterns it has learned
  - When you send a prompt it generates a response based on language patterns
- Because it is pattern-based and not fact-based, it can very confidently produce wrong information
- May or may not have memory between conversations, depending on platform

Terminology

- Generative AI (GenAI): a subset of artificial intelligence that creates new content
- Large Language Model (LLM): the mathematical backbone of GenAI
- Prompt: anything you type or say to GenAI to get a response
- Hallucination: when GenAI states something confidently that is wrong
- Sycophancy: the tendency for GenAI to agree with you, flatter you, or tell you what you want to hear rather than what is actually most accurate or helpful
- Context window: the amount of text GenAI can "see" and work with at one time
    - Includes everything you have typed in the current conversation and everything it has already responded with
- Token: the small chunks that GenAI breaks all text into before processing it

Safety, privacy, and what not to share

- LLMs live on external servers
- Do not put in any information you would not want to live on an external server
  - PII
  - Confidential/proprietary/sensitive data or information
- Treat every conversation as if it could be seen by someone else
- Do not use GenAI to make final decisions on anything with real consequences
- Do not assume that because it gave you a confident, well-written answer that it is correct
- Know your organization's policy before you use it at work

General rule: if you wouldn’t email it, don’t put it in GenAI

Platform tour and your first login

The anatomy of a good prompt

CRAFT: the anatomy of a good prompt

- C: Context
  - Set the scene of who you are and what you are trying to do
- R: Role
  - Who the AI should be in responding to you
- A: Avoid
  - What you do not want
- F: Format
  - How the AI should format the output
- T: Tweak
  - Your first prompt is just the starting point
  - The best answers come from going back and forth with the AI
  - The more you react and redirect, the better the output
  - Tweaks can be in the original prompt or as follow-on prompts, part of the conversation

DEMONSTRATION:

Updated Prompt from First Login

Approximate schedule

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2:25 - 2:30	BREAK
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3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Module 2: Summarization

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Summarization is one of the easiest wins you get can out of GenAI, but its quality depends heavily on the material (including the prompt) you provide it.
2. GenAI can hallucinate and miss subtle meaning, so always double check against the original source information.

What we are doing in this module

- Copy and paste messy, real-world content into AI
- Get back clean, executive summaries in under 3 minutes
- Content you deal with daily
  - Chaotic email threads
  - Long PDF reports that you don’t have time to read
  - Rambling meeting notes

Summarization is one of your easiest AI wins

- Gives you the fastest return
  - Low effort to learn
  - High payoff immediately
  - Works across every job function and industry
- A good entry point
- The thing that “sticks” because the results are obvious

The catch

- Summarization quality is only as good as what you give it
  - GIGO
  - What you are summarizing might be messy, but your prompt shouldn't be!
- Do not blindly trust the output
  - Hallucinations are more common with complex documents, numbers, names, and dates
  - Verify it against the original
  - Treat it like a very fast intern who sometimes make things up
- These are manageable problems!
- Rookie mistake: treating it like a copy machine
  - The best results come from intentionally prompting rather than passive copying

HANDS ON:

Email thread chaos

The scenario

- You just got back from vacation to a ton of unread emails
- One email is a lengthy chain with tons of forwards and replies about Project X, which is due on February 28th
- Another email is from your boss asking for an update on the status of Project X in 1 hour to include:
  - Are we on track for the deadline?
  - Are we on budget relative to the original $440k budget?
  - Are there any blockers?
  - Is the project in good shape or in trouble

The problem

https://raw.githubusercontent.com/ClairSullivan-Associates/genai_nontech/refs/heads/main/data/email.txt

CRAFT

- **C - Context** I'm preparing a status update for my boss who has a board meeting Monday. She needs a clear, accurate picture of Project X, which is supposed to launch by end of February. I'm pasting the full email thread below.
- **R - Role** You are a senior project analyst who specializes in translating messy communication threads into clean executive briefings.
- **A - Avoid** Do not include background noise, pleasantries, or side conversations that aren't relevant to project status. Do not editorialize or add opinions not supported by the thread. Do not assume information that isn't explicitly stated.

CRAFT (cont.)

- **F - Format** Structure your response around these four questions...
  1. Schedule status...are we on track, ahead, or behind? What is the current launch date?
  2. Budget status...are we over or under
  3. Current blockers or issues that need attention
  4. Overall project health...is everything ready?

  Close with 3 to 5 bullet points that my boss could read in 60 seconds.

- **T - Tweak** If the thread doesn't clearly answer one of the four questions, flag it as "unclear from available information" rather than guessing.

The solution prompt

I'm putting together a status update for my boss who has a board meeting Monday. She needs a clear picture of Project X, which is supposed to launch by end of February. I'm pasting the full email thread below.

You're a senior project analyst who's great at cutting through messy email threads and pulling out what actually matters for an executive audience.

Please work through these four questions...

1. Schedule status...are we on track, ahead, or behind? What is the current launch date?
2. Budget status...are we over or under?
3. Any current blockers or issues that need attention?
4. Overall project health...is everything ready to go?

Close with 3 to 5 bullet points my boss could read in 60 seconds flat.

One important thing...if the thread doesn't clearly answer one of those questions, just flag it as "unclear from available information" rather than filling in the gaps. I'd rather know what we don't know than get a confident-sounding answer that isn't actually in the thread.

[paste entire email thread here]

HANDS ON:

PDF quick brief

The scenario

- You work for a company that sells commercial kitchen equipment distributor based in Denver serving restaurants, hotels, and ski resorts across Colorado, Utah, and Wyoming
- You are at your desk and it is 4:19 pm on Friday
- Your Slack/Teams dings with you boss sending you a DM
- They have a 54 page document (the Federal Reserve Beige Book) that they have just sent you full of complicated economic information
- They ask "Hey, I need you to pull the key insights from this so I can brief the board on how current economic conditions might affect our business selling the Mountain West. Just give me the highlights on what is happening with consumer spending, restaurants, retail, and anything else related to our market."
- "I need it before you leave for the day."

The problem

https://www.federalreserve.gov/monetarypolicy/files/BeigeBook_20260114.pdf

CRAFT

- **C - Context** I work for a commercial kitchen equipment distributor based in Denver serving restaurants, hotels, and ski resorts across Colorado, Utah, and Wyoming. Our VP needs to brief the board Thursday on the health of the restaurant and hospitality sector in our market. I'm pasting the most recent Federal Reserve Beige Book below.
- **R - Role** You are a regional economist who specializes in translating Federal Reserve data into practical B2B sales intelligence...you think in terms of buying cycles, capital investment behavior, and how macro conditions hit specific industries in specific geographies.
- **A - Avoid** Skip anything that doesn't connect back to the Mountain West region or to restaurant and hospitality specifically. Leave out national consumer sentiment data that doesn't have implications for equipment purchasing. Don't summarize the whole Beige Book...we only need what's relevant to our market and our customer base.

CRAFT (cont.)

- **F - Format** Work through these four questions...
  1. What's happening with consumer spending at restaurants in the Mountain West and Western regions?
  2. Are there differences between high-end dining versus casual and quick-service restaurants?
  3. Any regional factors like weather, tourism, or shifting consumer behavior affecting restaurant demand?
  4. What's the outlook...should we expect restaurants to be investing in equipment or pulling back?

  Close with 3 to 5 bullets our VP could read in 90 seconds and walk into that board meeting feeling prepared.

- **T - Tweak** If the Beige Book has thin coverage of the Mountain West specifically, pull from the broader Western district and flag that you're doing so. Better to be transparent about the sourcing than to overstate what the data actually shows.

The solution prompt

I work for a commercial kitchen equipment distributor based in Denver serving restaurants, hotels, and ski resorts across Colorado, Utah, and Wyoming. Our VP is briefing the board Thursday on the health of the restaurant and hospitality sector in our region. I'm pasting the latest Federal Reserve Beige Book below.

Act as a regional economist who can translate Fed data into practical buying and investment signals for a B2B audience.

Focus on these four things...what's happening with restaurant consumer spending in the Mountain West and Western regions, whether high-end dining is tracking differently than casual and quick-service, any regional factors like tourism or weather affecting demand, and whether restaurants are likely to invest in equipment or hold back in the near term.

Skip anything that doesn't connect to our region or our customer base...we don't need a full Beige Book summary, just what's relevant to a kitchen equipment distributor planning inventory and sales.

Close with 3 to 5 bullets our VP can read in 90 seconds before walking into that boardroom.

If Mountain West coverage is thin, pull from the broader Western district and flag that you did so.

[paste Beige Book here]

HANDS ON:

Meeting notes rescue

The scenario

- Your company, Meridian Financial Group, is throwing their annual all-hands company conference in Chicago at a hotel in late March
- This year is their 25th anniversary so it's a much bigger deal than usual
  - 400+ attendees
  - People flying in from 6 regional offices
  - An outside keynote speaker
  - Formal gala on night 2
  - Team building activity
  - Full day of breakout sessions
- You have a bunch of messy notes from various planning meetings that you have been a part of…a small part of your job and one you don't think about much
- The CEO, Richard, asks for a quick meeting with you in 15 minutes to prepare him for a 2 pm meeting where he needs to know if this event is going to be pulled off, what is locked in, what is still dangling, what are the risks, and is anyone about to drop the ball

The problem

https://github.com/ClairSullivan-Associates/genai_nontech/blob/main/data/meeting_notes.md

CRAFT

- **C - Context** I have five weeks worth of planning meeting notes for Meridian Financial Group's 25th anniversary all-hands conference...400 employees, three days in Chicago, March 24 through 26. The notes are messy, full of typos, side conversations, and running commentary. Our CEO Richard Holt needs a clean briefing on where things stand and whether we're ready to execute.
- **R - Role** You are a chief of staff who has managed large-scale corporate events before...you know exactly what a CEO needs to walk into a briefing feeling confident, and you're great at separating the noise from what actually matters.
- **A - Avoid** Skip the interpersonal drama, the jokes, the food commentary, and anything that doesn't connect to event readiness, budget status, or open risks. Don't try to interpret the typos...just pull what's accurate and useful. Don't include vendor backstory unless it affects current status.

CRAFT (cont.)

- **F - Format** Organize the summary around these four areas...
  1. What is confirmed and locked in...venue, speakers, catering, AV, travel, gala, swag?
  2. What is still open or unresolved heading into the event?
  3. What are the budget numbers and how much cushion do we have left?
  4. Are there any risks the CEO should know about walking into this briefing?

  Close with 3 to 5 bullets Richard can read in 60 seconds before his 2pm meeting.

- **T - Tweak** If something appears multiple times across different weeks, use the most recent update as the source of truth. If anything is unclear or contradictory, flag it as "needs verification" rather than guessing.

The solution prompt

I have five weeks of planning meeting notes for a 400-person corporate anniversary conference in Chicago, March 24 through 26. The notes are messy and full of tangents. Our CEO needs a briefing today at 2pm on whether we're ready to execute.

Act as a chief of staff who knows what a CEO needs to hear before a high-stakes briefing...not the backstory, just what matters.

Work through these four things...what is fully confirmed across venue, speakers, catering, AV, travel, gala, and swag...what is still open or unresolved...where the budget stands and how much contingency remains...and any risks the CEO should know about walking in.

Leave out vendor history, interpersonal dynamics, and anything that doesn't connect to event readiness or budget. If something appears multiple times across different weeks, use the most recent version as the source of truth.

Close with 3 to 5 bullets the CEO can read in 60 seconds before his 2pm meeting.

If anything is unclear or contradictory, flag it as "needs verification" rather than guessing.

[paste meeting notes here]

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Summarization is one of the easiest wins you get can out of GenAI, but its quality depends heavily on the material (including the prompt) you provide it.
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3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Module 3: Text Generation

2 Key Concepts for this Module

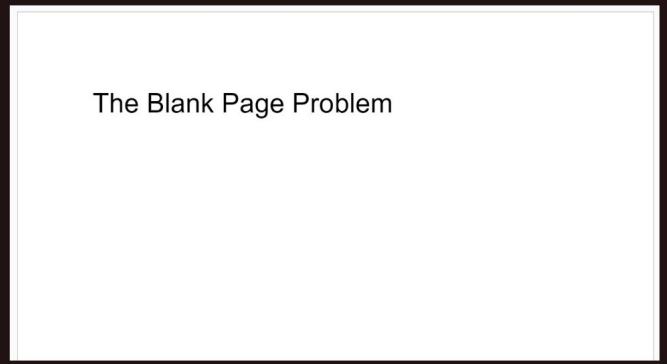
1. Most people freeze when they have to write something from scratch not because they don't know what to say but because they don't know how to start. GenAI eliminates that completely. That shift from "writer" to "director" is the whole point.
2. Your job is to edit, not just accept. Whatever the AI gives you is a starting point, not a finished product. The people who get the most out of text generation are the ones who treat the output like a draft. You must still use your voice and judgement.

The Blank Page Problem

Jared Turner – June 22, 2023

PRODUCTIVITY

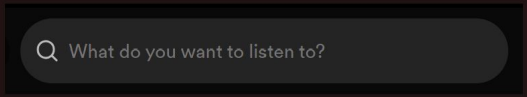
I had the idea for this post in July 2021. For almost two years it looked like this:



Every now and then I would get some energy, open up the page and stare at it.

"What should I write? Where do I start? Or should it be, *how* do I start? Now I'm procrastinating. Why is this so hard?"

Perhaps what I needed was some music playing to help give me a kickstart. I hopped over to Spotify...



What *do* I want to listen to? There are literally thousands of artists I love and yet I find myself staring at an empty search box and my mind is blank.

https://thoughtbot.com/blog/the-blank-page-problem

M

Some basic facts

- Writing is one of the most common and most dreaded tasks in the modern workplace
  - It’s not that people don’t know what they want to say
  - Starting from nothing is genuinely hard
- The mental energy it takes to write the first sentence is often more than it takes to write everything that follows
- GenAI doesn't make you a better writer, but rather makes the starting problem disappear

What text generation actually is

- GenAI is not doing the thinking for you
- It is helping you get unstuck
- You still do provide everything via CRAFT
- GenAI returns a competent first draft
- The output is raw material
- You still have the choice of what to do with it

The mental shift you need to make

- Writing from scratch is a task that requires a lot of mental energy
- Transition to make your task editing
  - Faster
  - Less draining
  - Produces more consistent results
- Not about lowering your standards
- Removes friction between what you know and what you need to produce
- The best output is still in your voice and sounds like you, but GenAI helped you get there faster

HANDS ON:

The difficult email

The scenario

- You are the customer success manager at a mid-sized B2B company
- Your team was responsible for delivering a completed onboarding package to a client, Hartwell & Associates, by March 1st that included account configuration, user access setup, and a training schedule for their team of 22 people
- It didn't go out until March 12th...eleven days late
- Reason for delay was internal handoff breakdown, falling through the cracks during a busy period
- End result was that it cost the client real time and money
- You receive an email from Patricia Nguyen who is furious, demanding an explanation, apology, and assurance it won’t happen again
- You need to respond today, taking accountability without making excuses

CRAFT

- C = ?
- R = ?
- A = ?
- F = ?
- T = ?

The solution prompt

I'm a customer success manager and I need to respond to an angry client email today. We were supposed to deliver a completed onboarding package to Hartwell and Associates by March 1st and it didn't go out until March 12th. The delay was caused by an internal handoff breakdown between our implementation and technical teams. Because of our mistake, the client had to cancel and reschedule internal training for 22 people which cost them real time and money. Their account lead Patricia Nguyen sent a professional but clearly furious email asking for an explanation, an apology, and assurance this won't happen again. Her contract renewal is also coming up in June so the relationship is on the line.

Act as a senior customer success professional who is skilled at turning damaged client relationships around through honest, confident communication.

Write a response email to Patricia that takes full accountability for the delay without making excuses, acknowledges the specific impact our mistake had on her team, and gives her two or three concrete steps we are taking to make sure this doesn't happen again. Keep the tone accountable and solution-focused...not groveling, not defensive.

Keep it to four paragraphs or less and make it something a real person would actually send...no corporate fluff, no hollow apologies.

If there are multiple ways to phrase the accountability section, give me two options for that paragraph so I can choose the tone that fits best.

HANDS ON:

SOP builder

The scenario

- Think of a process you do regularly at work
  - Something you are the “go to” person to explain to new colleagues
  - Something that has never been written down
  - Some ideas
    - How to handle a new client inquiry
    - How to process an order
    - How to hire a new staff member
    - Anything that has a beginning, middle, and end
- You have been asked to document it as a formal SOP so that new employees could follow it without needing to ask you questions
- You can explain it well enough but not well enough to write it from scratch

The solution prompt

I need to create a standard operating procedure for [describe the process in one or two sentences...what it is, who does it, and when it happens]. This process takes place at [describe your company or department in a sentence...industry, size, type of work you do].

Act as an experienced operations manager who is skilled at taking loosely described processes and turning them into clear, professional SOPs that a new employee could follow on day one.

Here are the steps I know are part of this process... [list the steps you know, even if they are rough or out of order...don't worry about making them perfect]

Using those steps as the foundation, fill in any gaps where a logical step is clearly missing, suggest any best practices a professional in this field would typically include, and flag anything that seems unclear or that you made an assumption about so I can verify it.

Format it as a proper SOP with a title, a brief purpose statement, a list of who this applies to, numbered steps in order, and any notes or warnings where relevant.

Keep the language clear and direct...this should be something a real employee would actually read and use, not a corporate document nobody opens.

[paste or list your process steps here]

HANDS ON:

The Ultimate Brainstormer

The scenario

- We are now going to treat GenAI like a thinking partner
  - Real power when you have a conversation with it
  - Don’t just put in a prompt and take the answer
  - Go back and forth
- I will demo first
- Your experiment
  - Suggested topics
    - “How might we improve new employee onboarding so people feel connected faster?”
    - “How could we make our client check-in process feel less transactional?”
    - “What can I, as the manager, do to improve team morale?”
    - “How can I work better with my remote team?”

CRAFT prompt

I'm trying to think through a business problem and I need a thinking partner to help me brainstorm. The context is [describe your company or team in a sentence...industry, size, what you do]. The problem I'm trying to solve is [describe the problem clearly...what's not working, what you're trying to improve, or what decision you're facing].

Act as a seasoned business strategist who asks good questions, challenges assumptions, and isn't afraid to suggest ideas that are a little unconventional.

Don't just give me a generic list of ideas...push me toward things that are specific to my situation. If you need more context to give me something useful, ask me for it before you dive in.

Please don't give me more than five ideas to start...I'd rather have five sharp ones than fifteen mediocre ones. For each idea give me one sentence on why it's worth considering.

Demo prompt

I'm trying to think through a business problem and I need a thinking partner to help me brainstorm. The context is a fully remote team of eight people spread across three time zones. We communicate through Slack and Zoom but things feel fragmented...collaboration is clunky, projects fall through the cracks, and people are starting to feel disconnected from each other. The manager wants to fix both the workflow and the team culture but adding more meetings is not the answer.

Act as a seasoned business strategist who asks good questions, challenges assumptions, and isn't afraid to suggest ideas that are a little unconventional.

Don't give me a generic list...push me toward things specific to my situation. Start with five ideas max and give me one sentence on why each one is worth considering.

Follow up questions

- These are interesting...I want to explore number two more. Can you go deeper on that one and give me three specific ways a remote team manager could actually implement it without it feeling forced or performative?
- Now what if I told you this team is spread across the US, the UK, and Southeast Asia...there is literally no time zone overlap that works for everyone. How does that change your thinking?
- Given this conversation, let’s synthesize the results into the single biggest thing we could do to improve.

Observations

- The first response was the “warm up”
- The useful stuff came out of the follow-up’s
- Introducing the constraint mid-conversation really changed the direction in a useful way
- The last question on synthesis would have take me a lot longer to reach on my own

Strategies for the conversation

- Ask it to narrow down to the top three ideas, push deeper, and explain why
- Ask it to give something more unexpected
- Ask it to argue against one of its own suggestions
- Ask it to consider a constraint you haven't mentioned yet
- Ask it to combine two of the ideas into one hybrid approach
- Ask it to tell you what's missing from the conversation so far
- Challenge the idea / play “devil’s advocate”
- At the end of the brainstorming conversation, ask it to synthesize the results into the biggest win

Your turn!

HANDS ON:

My Personal Tutor

The scenario

- You are a top-performing individual contributor on a sales team for 3 years
- Yesterday the VP pulled you into a one-on-one to tell you that your manager is leaving unexpectedly and you are being asked to step into that role tomorrow
- You have never managed anyone nor had a direct report
- You have less than a day to get ready and learn what you need to become a manager

Demo prompt

I need to learn the most important things about being a first time people manager as fast as possible. I was just told yesterday that I'm taking over as manager of a team of six sales reps starting tomorrow morning. I've never managed anyone before. I'm strong at the actual sales work but I have zero experience with the people management side.

Act as an experienced leadership coach who specializes in helping first time managers get up to speed quickly...you know what actually matters in the first 30 days and what can wait.

Teach me 80% of what I need to know in 20% of the time. Don't give me a textbook...give me the highest leverage things a first time manager gets wrong and what to do instead. Keep it to the five most important things and be specific...I need to be functional by tomorrow morning not polished by next year.

Skip the obvious stuff like "communicate clearly" and "be a good listener"...I need the things that actually trip up smart people who are new to managing.

Follow up questions

- You mentioned that managing people requires a completely different skill set than doing the work yourself. Can you explain what that actually means...like what specific mental shifts have to happen for someone to go from being great at a job to being great at leading people who do that job?
- I've always assumed that being the best performer on the team would make me a more credible manager because I know the work inside and out. Is that actually true or is that assumption going to get me in trouble?

Strategies for the conversation

- Fundamentally different from using GenAI as a task executor
- The quality of what you get back is all about how well you keep pushing
- Four key steps
  - Set your context specifically, don’t be generic
  - Go deeper, not broader, so it learns what matters to you
  - Challenge what you are being told, whether your assumptions are right or wrong, and to argue against itself
  - “What am I not asking that I should be?”

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Most people freeze when they have to write something from scratch not because they don't know what to say but because they don't know how to start. GenAI eliminates that completely. That shift from "writer" to "director" is the whole point.
2. Your job is to edit, not just accept. Whatever the AI gives you is a starting point, not a finished product. The people who get the most out of text generation are the ones who treat the output like a draft. You must still use your voice and judgement.

Approximate schedule

9:00 - 9:10	Orientation
9:10 - 10:00	Module 1
10:00 - 10:05	BREAK
10:05 - 11:00	Module 2
11:00 - 11:05	BREAK
11:05 - 12:00	Module 3
12:00 - 12:30	MIDPOINT BREAK
12:30 - 1:25	Module 4
1:25 - 1:30	BREAK
1:30 - 2:25	Module 5
2:25 - 2:30	BREAK
2:30 - 3:30	Module 6
3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Module 4: Data Analysis

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Data literacy is no longer a prerequisite for data insight. GenAI can help you translate raw numbers into answers, plots, and decisions.
2. Dealing with datasets, particularly as they get larger, can be complicated. Different platforms will provide you different quality of results.

How GenAI changes everything for non-analysts

- Historically, getting insights from a spreadsheet required formulas, pivot tables, or a favor from someone good with Excel
- GenAI flattens that barrier entirely
- This does not replace analysts, but it removes the bottleneck of needing one for every small question
- The skill being built here is not technical, it is knowing how to ask

What GenAI can actually do with data

- Identify which number are high, low, or unusual relative to the rest of the dataset
- Spot trends over time
- Flag anomalies
- Summarize a full table in plain language
- Generate questions a skeptical audience would ask
- Compare things without any formulas

What it canNOT do

- Work with very large datasets without additional tools
- Fast analysis (relative to text generation)
- Handle merged cells gracefully
- Provide good answers without CRAFT
- Recalculate spreadsheet the way Excel / Google Sheets does
- **Protect your sensitive data!!!**

How to provide data effectively

- GenAI is tolerant of messy formatting
  - ...but it doesn't always understand PDF tables
  - Try to keep the format consistent
    - CSV or TSV is great!
- Include column headers
- If the table is large, paste the most relevant sections rather than the entire file
- Some platforms allow you to attach the file directly
- Working within a spreadsheet (Copilot in Excel, Gemini in Sheets) can be much more efficient

CRAFTing data analysis prompts

- Be sure to provide context on:
  - What the table is
  - What you are trying to do with the information
    - Presentation?
    - Investigating a problem?
    - Preparing for a meeting?
  - What your business is
- Role should include something about yourself
  - Ex: “Explain this to me like I have no background in finance”
- Format can include plots
  - Be sure to ask for what you would like plotted or a plot to demonstrate the insight(s) being extracted

HANDS ON:

Quick data summary

The scenario

- You are a sales manager for an online retail store
- Your boss has asked for an update on monthly sales over the past 3 year period
- This is a pretty vague request and you want to anticipate 3 questions they might ask you
- It might also be helpful to know what stands out immediately in the data, such as outliers
- You will likely be asked if there is any one number that stands out more than the others
- Some (all?) of the data could be interpreted more than one way

The problem

https://github.com/ClairSullivan-Associates/genai_nontech/blob/main/data/monthly_sales.csv

The solution prompt

```
I am a sales manager for an online retail company and I need help
understanding this data quickly. You are a senior business analyst who is
great at explaining numbers in plain English to people who are not data
experts.

Here is the data: [paste table].

Please tell me three things: what stands out immediately, any months or
categories that look like outliers, and three questions a senior leader
would likely ask when reviewing this. Write everything in plain English
using short paragraphs, not jargon. If anything in the data could be
interpreted more than one way, flag it instead of assuming. And if there
is one number I should pay the most attention to before walking into a
meeting with this, tell me what it is and why.
```

HANDS ON:

Spot the trend

The scenario

- You are the operations manager, not a numbers person, for an online retail company
- The owner has asked you to come to next week's quarterly review prepared to answer questions on the health of the business over the past three years
- She has 3 specific questions on her agenda:
  - Is the business actually growing or does it just feel that way?
  - Are there any seasonal patterns we should be planning around better…for inventory, staffing, and cash flow?
  - Anything in the numbers that concerns you or that we should be paying closer attention to?
- You have 15 minutes before your next call and you want to walk into that meeting with a real point of view, not just a printed spreadsheet

The solution prompt

Utilizing the same dataset I need help analyzing and I want to understand what's actually going on inside it. I'm not a data analyst and I don't need a technical breakdown...I need someone to help me see the story the numbers are telling.

Act as a data analyst who is great at explaining patterns in plain language to non-technical audiences...you know how to spot what's interesting, what's concerning, and what's just noise.

Please review this dataset and tell me three things. First, are there any overall trends...is something consistently going up, going down, or flattening out over time? Second, is there any seasonality...do certain patterns repeat at predictable intervals like weekly, monthly, or quarterly cycles? Third, are there any anomalies...data points that don't fit the pattern and might be worth investigating further? For each thing you find give me a plain language explanation of what you're seeing and why it might matter. Don't just describe the numbers...tell me what they might mean for the business. If the dataset is too limited or messy to draw confident conclusions, tell me that clearly rather than overreaching. I'd rather know the limits of the analysis than walk away with false confidence.

Provide a plot to demonstrate your key findings

HANDS ON:

Meeting prep from data

The scenario

- You have been given the sales data by category and must prepare for a meeting on strategic planning with the executives
- You need to make recommendations for strategic questions backed by data
  - Which product categories are driving the most revenue and should we be doubling down on them?
  - Where are we losing the most money to returns and is there a pattern worth addressing?
  - Which categories have high unit volume but low revenue per item...and does that matter?
- You also want to make sure you can handle questions from the executives on the overall health of the product mix and general things in the data that the executives might find uncomfortable

The problem

https://github.com/ClairSullivan-Associates/genai_nontech/blob/main/data/product_sales.csv

The solution prompt

I'm a sales manager for an online retail company preparing for a strategic planning meeting where we need to make decisions about our product mix and where to focus our energy going forward.

This is a sales dataset that breaks down performance by product category including gross sales, discounts, returns, and total net sales. Act as a strategic business analyst who is comfortable working with messy sales data and translating numbers into clear recommendations that non-financial people can actually act on.

Please work through these questions...which product categories are driving the most revenue and does the data suggest we should be doubling down on them...which categories have the healthiest margin after discounts and returns are factored in...which categories have high unit volume but low revenue per item and what if anything does that signal...and if we had to cut or deprioritize two categories based purely on what the data shows, which ones would be the candidates and why? Then close with an executive briefing section...if you had five minutes to brief a leadership team on the health of this product mix, what would you say? Include the two or three things in this data that should make leadership at least pause and ask questions.

Don't just describe the numbers...tell me what they mean and what they suggest we should do. If something in the data is unclear or could be interpreted multiple ways, flag it rather than forcing a conclusion.

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Data literacy is no longer a prerequisite for data insight. GenAI can help you translate raw numbers into answers, plots, and decisions.
2. Dealing with datasets, particularly as they get larger, can be complicated. Different platforms will provide you different quality of results.

Approximate schedule

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1:25 - 1:30	BREAK
1:30 - 2:25	Module 5
2:25 - 2:30	BREAK
2:30 - 3:30	Module 6
3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Module 5: Image Generation

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Adjectives are doing all the work. Nouns tell the AI what to show. Adjectives tell it how to show it.
2. Describe the photo, not the concept, including visual style. Every word you skip is a decision you hand to the algorithm. AI will make assumptions to fill any gap in your prompt, and those assumptions are rarely what you had in mind.

Why most AI images disappoint

- Most people type a concept into an image generator and are disappointed with what comes back
- It all has to do with the prompt not being specific enough
  - Generic: “a meeting room”
  - Specific: “A bright, modern meeting room with floor to ceiling windows and natural light”
- Every detail you leave out is a creative decision the algorithm makes for you
- The fix is not a better tool, but rather a better brief

Image generation limits on the popular platforms

	Free Tier	**First Paid Tier**
ChatGPT	~2-3 images / day	~50 images / 3 hours
Claude	*No image generation capabilities!!!*	
Copilot	15 / day	Exact value not published but likely ~ 100 / day*
Gemini	20 / day	50 / day

* per Claude

Some notes on these limits

- “Per day” typically means that it resets after 24 hours
- Editing an image counts as 1 image generation
- Because these limits are so low (especially for the free version!), it is important to really precisely describe what you are looking for in the prompt!
  - Use T of CRAFT to have GenAI help you write the prompt before actually generating the image
- Your workplace might offer you a GenAI plan that goes beyond the free tier
  - Copilot built into MS products
  - Gemini built into Google products
  - These frequently will do a better job of making images suited to docs and slides

MAKE IT BETTER:

“A business meeting”

MAKE IT BETTER:

“A leader presenting to a team”

Describe the photo, not the concept

- Abstract concepts like "innovation," "trust," and "growth" have no visual form the AI can render consistently
- Context: what does this concept look like in a photograph? What are the people doing? Where are they? What is the light like?
- Visual style is one of the most skipped and most important elements
  - Photorealistic
  - Flat illustration
  - Editorial photograph
  - Corporate photograph
- Think of your prompt as describing a photograph that already exists in your mind to someone who cannot see it

Anatomy of a strong image prompt

- Subject
  - What is the main focus?
  - Concrete nouns
- Adjectives and details
  - Describe the subject with specifics
    - Age, expression, setting, size, color, texture
- Visual style
- Lighting
  - Natural light, soft light, studio lighting, golden hour, overhead light, etc.
- Shot type
  - Close up, wide shot, overhead, eye level, etc.
- What to exclude
  - Text
  - No cluttered backgrounds, distorted hands, etc.

Image generation via CRAFT

- **C - Context:** Set the scene. Where is this taking place and why? "For a corporate internal presentation slide about employee wellness..."
- **R - Role:** Tell the AI how to approach the image. "Act as a professional corporate photographer shooting for a Fortune 500 annual report..."
- **A - Avoid:** Be explicit about what you do not want. "Avoid stock photo clichés, avoid text in the image, avoid cluttered backgrounds, avoid distorted faces or hands..."
- **F - Format:** Specify the visual format and shot type. "Wide shot, 16:9 aspect ratio, flat illustration style with muted earth tones..."
- **T — Tweak:** Use the same conversation thread to refine. "Keep everything the same but change the lighting to natural window light and make the team more diverse..."

Examples

Everything You Wanted
to Know About
GenAI
but were Afraid to Ask
(in 5 minutes or less)
CLAIR SULLIVAN
& ASSOCIATES

Examples

Given the attached image, make a new image with the same theme (removing the logo for Clair Sullivan & Associates) with the title "Your First Prompt: The Email Makeover".

Examples

Take this photo and turn it into a headshot that is appropriate for theater. In other words, remove the background and turn it into a solid color. DO NOT CHANGE ANYTHING ABOUT THE APPEARANCE OF THE PERSON IN THE PHOTO.

HANDS ON:

The Executive Presentation

The scenario

- You are the HR director at a mid-sized financial services firm
- Your CHRO has asked you to present the results of this year's employee engagement survey to the executive leadership team next Friday
- You need a strong hero image for the opening slide that sets a serious, professional tone before you say a single word but every image you find from you company’s stock photo library looks generic and dated

The solution prompt

I am an HR director at a mid-sized financial services firm preparing a presentation on employee engagement survey results for the executive leadership team.

Act as a corporate editorial photographer shooting for a premium financial services firm's internal leadership communication, with the aesthetic of Harvard Business Review cover photography rather than a typical HR stock photo library. Avoid clichéd poses like handshakes, people pointing at whiteboards, or forced smiles at cameras, and avoid text, watermarks, logos, and cluttered backgrounds.

A confident, polished woman in her 40s standing at the head of a sleek modern boardroom, gesturing toward a large screen displaying clean data visualizations, four or five senior executives seated around a long dark conference table listening with focused attention, the room bathed in soft warm light from floor to ceiling windows, expressions serious and engaged, leather chairs, glass water pitchers, and open notebooks on the table suggesting a high stakes professional setting. Wide shot, 16:9 aspect ratio, muted sophisticated color palette of deep navy blues and warm charcoal grays, shallow depth of field pulling focus to the presenter.

HANDS ON:

The Onboarding Deck

The scenario

- You work in People and Culture at a large healthcare organization
- Your team is rebuilding the new hire onboarding experience and you have been asked to create a 3-image visual set for the welcome section of the onboarding deck
- The images need to feel warm, human, and inclusive with the same style, tone, and energy
- The images must include:
  - Someone getting settled at their workspace
  - A new employee meeting their team
  - A group training session in progress

The solution prompt (1)

I work in People and Culture at a large healthcare organization and need a warm, human, and inclusive image for the welcome section of a new hire onboarding deck.

Act as an editorial photographer shooting for a progressive, people-first healthcare brand, with the warmth and authenticity of a modern employee experience campaign rather than a clinical or corporate stock photo library. Avoid sterile hospital settings, posed smiles, cluttered desks, text, watermarks, and anything that feels cold or institutional.

A young woman of color in her late 20s sitting down at a clean bright desk for the first time, arranging a few personal items next to her laptop, a soft genuine smile on her face suggesting quiet excitement, warm natural light coming from a window to her left, a modern open plan office with blurred colleagues working in the background suggesting a welcoming busy environment, a small welcome plant and a branded notebook visible on the corner of the desk. Wide shot, 16:9 aspect ratio, warm natural color palette of soft whites, greens, and warm wood tones, shallow depth of field. If the first result feels too posed, follow up in the same thread asking to capture her looking down at her desk rather than at the camera to create a more candid authentic moment.

The solution prompt (2)

```
Now generate a second image in exactly the same visual
style, color palette, lighting, and energy as the first
image. This time show a diverse group of four colleagues in
a bright modern break room gathered around a new team
member, mid-conversation and mid-laugh, one person leaning
in to shake hands warmly while others smile naturally, a mix
of ages and ethnicities, casual professional attire, coffee
cups and a small plant on the counter in the background.
Medium shot, 16:9 aspect ratio.
```

The solution prompt (3)

```
Now generate a third image maintaining the exact same visual
style, color palette, lighting, and energy as the first two
images. This time show a diverse group of six employees
seated around a large bright table in a modern training
room, one confident facilitator standing at the front
gesturing toward a clean presentation screen, participants
leaning forward with open notebooks and laptops, expressions
curious and engaged. Wide shot, 16:9 aspect ratio.
```

HANDS ON:

The Numbers Need a Face

The scenario

- You are a financial analyst at a regional bank preparing the annual community impact report that goes out to shareholders, board members, and local media
- The focus of this report is on community grants and people being engaged in a community activity or space
- The report is full of data, but lacks the feel of there being real people behind the numbers
- You need to create an image that puts a human face on the data without feeling manipulated or staged

The solution prompt

I am a financial analyst at a regional bank preparing an annual community impact report for shareholders, board members, and local media, and I need an image that puts a human face on our community grants data without feeling manipulative or staged.

Act as a documentary photographer shooting for a respected regional publication, with the authenticity and warmth of a National Geographic community story rather than a charity campaign or corporate social responsibility brochure. Avoid anything that looks posed, pitying, or performative, and avoid text, watermarks, logos, and overly polished settings that feel disconnected from real community life.

A multigenerational group of six to eight community members of diverse ages and ethnicities working together outdoors in a bright well-maintained community garden, some kneeling in the soil planting seedlings with dirt on their hands, others passing tools or water to each other, an older man laughing with a teenage girl beside a raised garden bed, genuine expressions of effort and connection rather than awareness of the camera, a warm sunny afternoon casting golden natural light across the scene, modest homes and trees softly blurred in the background grounding the image in a real neighborhood rather than an abstract space. Wide shot, 16:9 aspect ratio, warm earthy color palette of greens, browns, and golden yellows, natural depth of field keeping the full group in focus.

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. Adjectives are doing all the work. Nouns tell the AI what to show. Adjectives tell it how to show it.
2. Describe the photo, not the concept, including visual style. Every word you skip is a decision you hand to the algorithm. AI will make assumptions to fill any gap in your prompt, and those assumptions are rarely what you had in mind.

Approximate schedule

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2:25 - 2:30	BREAK
2:30 - 3:30	Module 6
3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Module 6: Agentic AI

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. An agent is an AI system that uses a reasoning loop to autonomously plan, execute, and evaluate a sequence of tasks in order to reach a defined goal
2. Agents use tools to expand its functionality so it is able to combine the reasoning of the LLM with sophisticated capabilities (enabled by the use of one or multiple tools) to complete whole goals rather than relying on a back-and-forth with the user

What is an agent?

- Most GenAI interactions are transactional
  - You ask, it answers, the conversation ends
- Agents are given goals that it works towards across multiple steps
- The agent decides what to do next without waiting for you to prompt it
- Agents plan, execute, and evaluate their output and continue this loop until the goal is reached
- Either the goal is achieved or the agent checks in with you
- NOT a smarter chatbot

How the reasoning loop works

- 3 stages
  - Plan
    - Breaks the goal into a sequence of steps
  - Act
    - Executes each step by either generating content or calling a **tool**
  - Observe
    - Evaluates what was produced and decides what to do next
- Repeats until goal is reached
- Understanding this loop is the foundation of building and using agents effectively
  - Clearly state the goal!

Tools

- A reasoning loop alone can only do what the language model can do
- Tools are small functions or programs that give agents the ability to interact with the world beyond generating text
  - Web search
  - Code execution
  - File reading
  - Form submission
  - Calls to external services
- At each step in the loop the agent decides whether it needs a tool and which one to use
- The tool returns a result and the agent incorporates that result into its next step
- Many browser-based platforms have some limited tool capabilities

DEMO:

LLM calls with and without tools

Agents versus prompts: what is different?

- A prompt asks the AI to *produce* something
- An agent asks the AI to *achieve* something
- With an agent the AI carries output from one step to the next itself
  - The agent manages the workflow
- The goal you set at the beginning governs every decision the agent makes along the way

Why this matters

- Most office work is a repetitive, multi-step process well-suited to agents
  - Research then summarize
  - Draft then revise
  - Gather then report
- Instead of spending an hour prompting back and forth to get a usable output, you define the goal once and the agent works through the steps to get there

How to change CRAFT for agents

- A regular CRAFT prompt defines a task to complete, assumes one pass
- You must add the goal, definition of done
- (A)void should specify what tasks the agent cannot do across the entire process, not just the final answer
  - Assumptions it cannot make
  - What to do if it hits an unknown or snag
- (F)ormat must describe sequence of steps for the agent to take and what should be produced at each
- (T)weak should provide evaluation criteria

HANDS ON:

Decisions based on multiple sources

The scenario

- Same commercial kitchen equipment distributor in Denver as earlier
- Higher stakes
- The VP of Sales has been asked by the CEO to evaluate whether the company should open a new sales territory in New Mexico
- She has 48 hours to deliver a recommendation to the executive team
- "I need you to dig into this for me. I have pulled together a few documents but I need someone to go through all of it, connect the dots, and give me a set of pros and cons with a final recommendation and the reasoning behind it. I need this by end of day. Here is what I have."
  - A regional economic snapshot for New Mexico covering GDP, employment, and consumer spending trends
  - A restaurant and hospitality industry report for New Mexico covering growth, segment mix, and investment patterns
  - A competitor activity summary showing which equipment distributors are already operating in New Mexico and what they are doing
  - An internal company memo summarizing their current capacity, open sales positions, and expansion budget

The problem

https://github.com/ClairSullivan-Associates/genai_nontech/blob/main/data/Document*.docx

The solution prompt (1)

Context:

You are helping me evaluate whether our company, a commercial kitchen equipment distributor, should expand into a new sales territory. I am providing you with four documents: a regional economic snapshot, a restaurant and hospitality industry report, a competitor activity summary, and an internal company memo from our VP of Sales. These documents contain conflicting signals and you will need to reason across all four of them to reach a defensible recommendation. Do not treat any single document as the complete picture.

Role:

Act as a senior business strategy analyst who specializes in market entry decisions for B2B distributors. You understand how to weigh market opportunity against operational readiness and competitive risk.

Avoid:

Do not summarize each document in isolation. Do not reach a conclusion before you have worked through all four documents. Do not make assumptions about information that is not in the documents. Do not ignore contradictions between documents, flag them explicitly. Do not skip the self evaluation step before moving to your final recommendation.

The solution prompt (2)

Format:

Work through this in four sequential steps and tell me when you are moving from one step to the next.

Step 1: Read all four documents and identify the three strongest signals in favor of expansion and the three strongest signals against it. Present these before moving on.

Step 2: Identify any points where the documents contradict each other or where one document complicates a conclusion from another. Present these conflicts explicitly before moving on.

Step 3: Evaluate whether you have enough information to make a confident recommendation or whether there are critical gaps. Tell me what you know, what you are uncertain about, and what is missing. Then tell me whether you are confident enough to proceed to a recommendation.

Step 4: Deliver a structured pros and cons analysis followed by a clear go or no go recommendation with the top three reasons supporting your decision.

Tweak:

Before delivering your final recommendation in Step 4, pause and ask yourself: have I given equal weight to the risks in the internal memo as I have to the market opportunity in the industry report? If the recommendation feels one sided, revisit the risk factors before finalizing it.

What makes this agentic

- Context stopped being about providing background information and became a “mission briefing”
  - Must **reason across sources** rather than summarize them
    - Activates reasoning loop
- Role stayed similar but became more specific on the kind of judgement required
  - Strategy analyst who weighs opportunity against operational readiness must think, not just report
- Avoid provides guardrails on the loop
  - What it cannot do at any decision point
  - Do not conclude early
  - Do not ignore contradictions
  - Do not skip self evaluation

What makes this agentic (cont.)

- Format had big transformations
  - Described workflow
  - Gave explicit handoffs between steps
  - Stated requirements to surface its work at each stage before proceeding
- Tweak no longer about style adjustments
  - Became the self-evaluation trigger
  - Forces agent to audit its own reasoning before delivering answer

A regular CRAFT prompt tells the AI what to produce. An agentic CRAFT prompt tells the AI how to think its way to a conclusion, and holds it accountable at every step along the way.

HANDS ON:

Web research

The scenario

- You are the HR manager at a mid-size health and wellness products company based in Chicago, IL with 180 employees
- You sell supplements, fitness equipment, and wellness coaching programs direct to consumer through your website and through retail partners
- Your CEO has asked you to find a staffing and recruiting agency to help fill a wave of 12 open positions across sales, customer service, and warehouse operations
  - "I don't want the biggest agency in the country. I want someone who actually knows our market and will treat us like a real client, not an afterthought."
- You have never used an outside agency before
- You have two weeks to come back with a recommendation

The solution prompt (1)

Context:

I am the HR Manager at a 180-person health and wellness products company in Chicago, Illinois. We need to hire 12 people across sales, customer service, and warehouse operations in the next 60 days. I have never worked with an external staffing agency before and my CEO wants a recommendation for an agency that specializes in our market and will treat a mid-size company as a priority client rather than a low-value account. I need you to research this for me and come back with a recommendation I can present to my CEO.

Role:

Act as an experienced HR consultant who has evaluated and selected staffing agencies for mid-size companies. You know what questions to ask, what red flags to look for, and how to evaluate whether an agency is genuinely suited to a client or just chasing a contract.

Avoid:

Do not recommend the largest national agencies by default simply because they are well known. Do not present a list of options without a clear recommendation. Do not skip any search step before moving to the next one. Do not fabricate agency details, reviews, or pricing. If a search returns limited or unclear results tell me what you found and what you are doing next to fill the gap.

The solution prompt (2)

Format:

Work through this in five sequential steps and narrate exactly what you are searching for and why before each search.

Step 1: Search for staffing agencies that specialize in health, wellness, or consumer products companies in Chicago, Illinois. Tell me what search terms you are using and why, then report what you found before moving on.

Step 2: Search for reviews, reputation signals, and any red flags for the top two or three agencies you identified in Step 1. Narrate your search approach, report what you found, and flag anything that concerns you.

Step 3: Search for what mid-size companies should look for when evaluating a staffing agency, specifically around contract terms, fee structures, and guarantees. Report the key criteria you found before moving on.

Step 4: Evaluate your top candidates against the criteria from Step 3. Tell me how each one measures up based on what you found and identify which one you are leaning toward and why.

Step 5: Deliver a final recommendation with the agency name, the reasons you selected them over the others, the key questions I should ask them in an introductory call, and any risks I should be aware of going in.

Tweak:

Before finalizing your recommendation in Step 5, ask yourself whether this agency genuinely fits a 180-person company or whether your recommendation is defaulting to size and name recognition. If you cannot find specific evidence that they work well with mid-size clients, flag that gap explicitly rather than glossing over it.

2 Key Concepts for this Module

1. An agent is an AI system that uses a reasoning loop to autonomously plan, execute, and evaluate a sequence of tasks in order to reach a defined goal
2. Agents use tools to expand its functionality so it is able to combine the reasoning of the LLM with sophisticated capabilities (enabled by the use of one or multiple tools) to complete whole goals rather than relying on a back-and-forth with the user

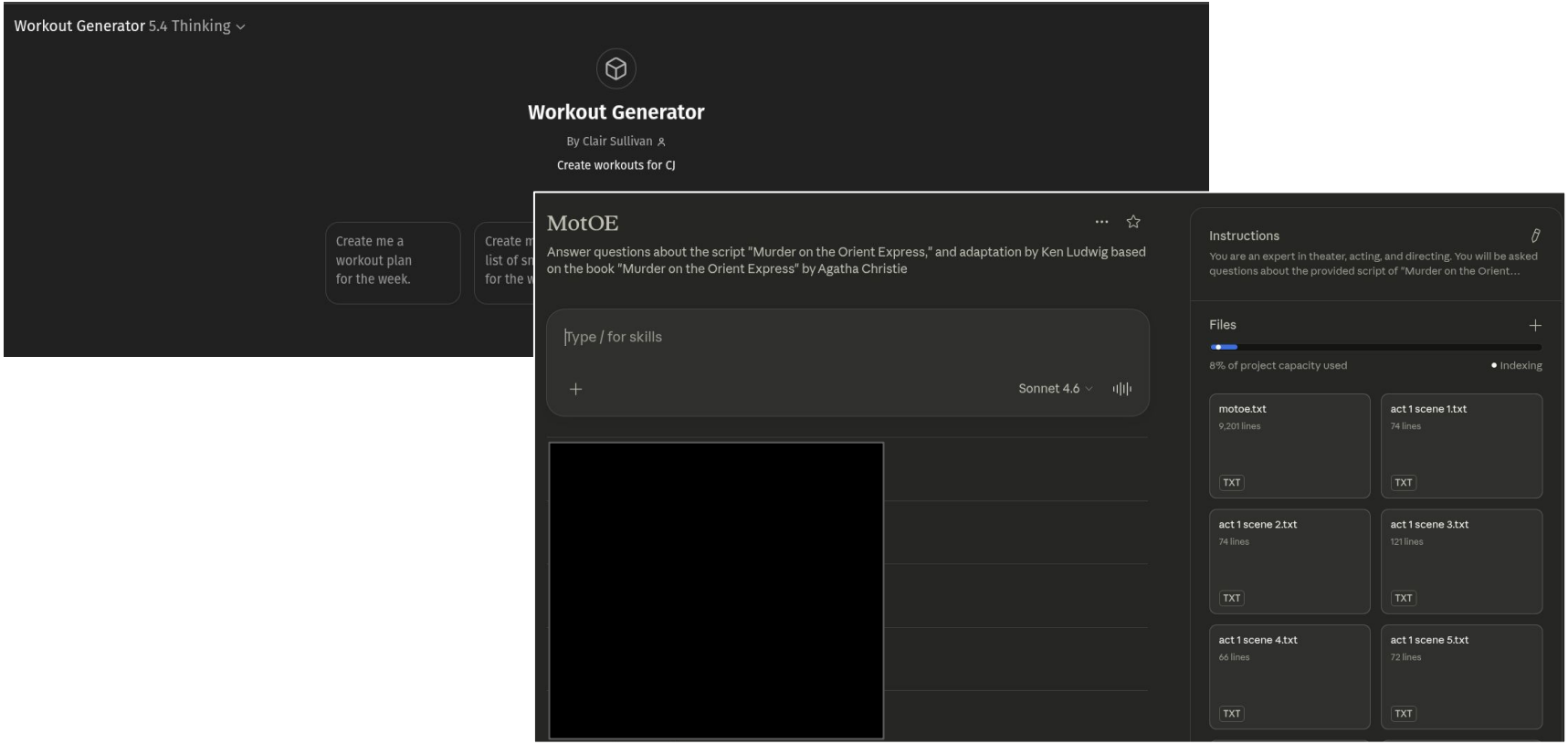
Approximate schedule

9:00 - 9:10	Orientation
9:10 - 10:00	Module 1
10:00 - 10:05	BREAK
10:05 - 11:00	Module 2
11:00 - 11:05	BREAK
11:05 - 12:00	Module 3
12:00 - 12:30	MIDPOINT BREAK
12:30 - 1:25	Module 4
1:25 - 1:30	BREAK
1:30 - 2:25	Module 5
2:25 - 2:30	BREAK
2:30 - 3:30	Module 6
3:30 - 4:00	Module 7

Module 7: Prompt Library Build and Wrap Up

Jump to GitHub

Try out custom GPTs, projects



Wrap up and next steps

- You now have a 10+ prompt library
  - Use these as starting point templates
- Practice!!!
- Get to know your corporate policies regarding the use of GenAI
  - If your office doesn’t have one, offer to help write it!
- Try other platforms and see if you develop a favorite over time
  - Even better, try and understand WHY it becomes your favorite!
- The space changes quickly, follow the news on GenAI

2 Key Concepts of the Course

1. GenAI is here to stay. Like the advent of computers or the internet, staying successful in your workplace requires knowing how to use it as a tool (NOT a human replacement!) to get work done.
2. Getting started with GenAI is simple and extracting overall workplace efficiencies out of it does not need to be complicated if you use some simple rules and frameworks for prompting it.

SURVEY

Thank you!

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